Interview guide

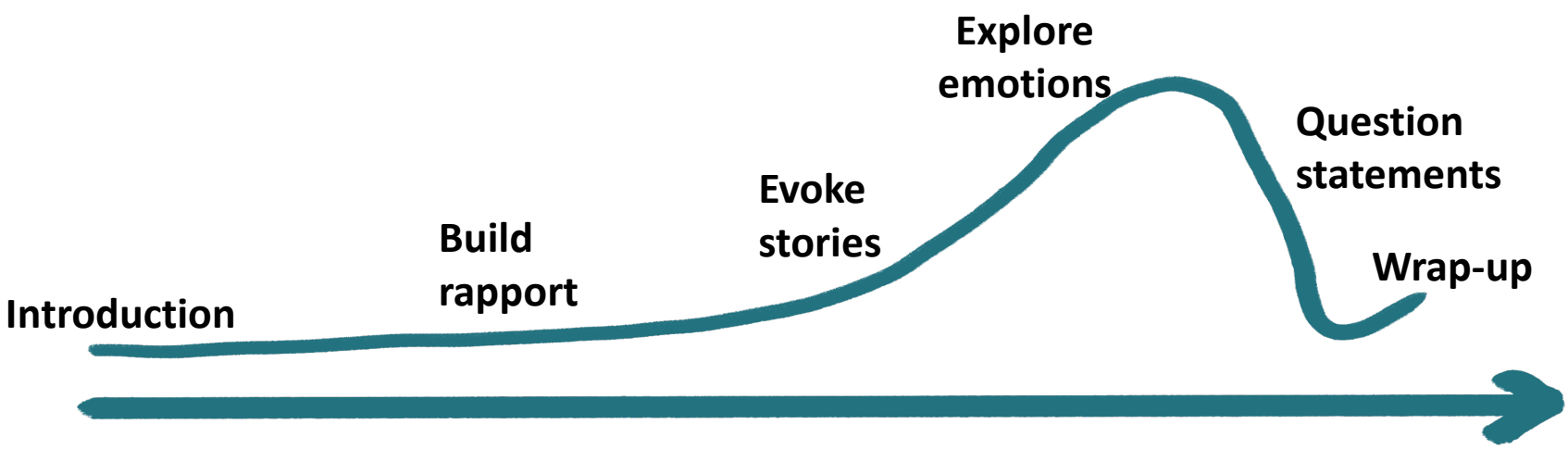
Name:

Date:

Version:

Structure and principles

Every interview is different, but you should try to make it feel like a natural conversation and not like an interrogation. This model helps.



Principles of interviews

To ensure a good interview, you should follow these principles for how you as an interviewer should behave during user interviews.

Allow the user to talk:

- Encourage stories: Whether or not the stories people tell are true, they reveal how the user perceives the world. Stories reveal what people find normal, acceptable and believe to be true. A good interview should let the user elaborate on the answers, in the same way as in a normal conversation.
- Keep an eye out for inconsistencies: Sometimes what people say and what they do are different. These discrepancies often obscure interesting insights. You should inquire into these discrepancies during a conversation.
- Follow up with the "why" question: Even when you think you know the answer, ask people why they say or do things. The answers will often surprise you.
- Listen to verbal and non-verbal cues: Pay attention to emotions and body language as a way to use the interview to build empathy with the user.

As an interviewer, you listen:

- Don't suggest answers: Even if someone pauses before they respond, don't help by suggesting an answer. This can inadvertently cause a person to say things that match your expectations.
- Ask questions neutrally: "What do you think of this idea?" is a better question than "Don't you think this idea is good?" because the first question doesn't imply that there's a real answer.
- Don't be afraid of silence: Interviewers often feel the need to ask another question when there is a break. Often, if you allow there to be silence, a person will reflect on what they have just said and say something deeper.

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Interview themes

Write the core themes that you want the interview to be about.

E.g. Airport security check-up, airport experiences...

Interview questions

Write the questions you intend to ask the interviewee

Introduction

For example, "My name is Poul and am reimagining our airport security area.... ”

Kick-off

For example, "When was the last time you were on a flight?...”

Build trust

For example, "Where do you like to go?...”

Deepen

For example, "Can you describe the most memorable security experience you've had?... Where was the memorable? …”

Reflect

For example, "If you were to design the perfect airport experience, how would it be?...”

Round

For example, "Thank you for your help, it has been a great help to see the airport through your eyes”

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